

Personal Organic Assistant

Not satisfied with the plethora of GSM handsets available in the market? You can have a phone adorned with gold, silver or even platinum if you wish. VERTU, an independently run subsidiary of Nokia has started selling such luxury phones since 2002 in Asia, Europe and the U.S. The highlight of such phones is custom-made software, which will allow customers to receive and make calls, contact book, calendar, and of course, play games. The approximate cost of such a phone will be around \$ 21,240.

The VERTU phones, which are strictly targeted for the elite segment, will be built on Nokia's technology and some of its parts. VERTU will assemble and customize the technology to suit its clients. It will also add exclusive parts, such as high-quality antennae, microphones and displays, and produce casings made out of precious metals.

Such phones are to have a special key on their side, which will allow clients to connect to a team of operators who have, for example, specialised information on travel and entertainment, and offer assistance in major cities around the world—a personal assistant of sorts.

The standard kit will come with a charger, portable hands free set, a CD and a data cable. You can also purchase a keypad, if you have the money to shell out.

Apart from the branded stuff, there are people who are willing to add diamonds and gold to your phone. Check out Web sites such as www.aloisson.com, and www.goldcom.org, for more information.



Drop them a line

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Prices mentioned are indicative in nature and are subject to change

What it all leads to...

Although popular, Nokia has failed to win any awards in our test. The reason for this being that Nokia has not revised their pricing policy—their models cost nearly the same as they used to a year ago. On the other hand, Sony Ericsson has come out with models that are more feature-rich and are priced less than any comparable Nokia sets.

The Best Value award went to the Sony Ericsson T200—it costs less than the Nokia 3610 or the 3350, packs in more features than these competitors and manages to come out looking good too. A nice blend of the right price and enticing features ensured the crown that it got.

The Best Performance award went to the Sony Ericsson P800. With an ARM 9 series processor powering the excellent Symbian v7.0 OS, this phone gets off on the right foot. It won because it is an impressive PDA, a truly functional phone device, with support for external memory, a great screen, wonderful audio and video capabilities, and Bluetooth connectivity that works flawlessly. ■

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